

Assignment 1 | Learning | Product Immersion

1. Executive Summary

Most of India's older adults – around 153 million – don't get enough support when moving around cities. A chance sits wide open for Uber to step in first, launching a service built only for seniors' travel needs. Instead of rushing into crowded markets, they could roll out a membership style ride system tailored just for this group. While others wait, being early means shaping how elderly trips work across the country. Timing matters because demand grows quietly, without noise, yet it's rising steadily beneath the surface

2. Market Analysis

Key Data Point 1 — Market Size

India is on the verge of a demographic transformation that very few industries have truly prepared for. As of 2024, India's elderly population those aged 60 and above stands at approximately 153 million people, making it one of the largest aging populations in the world. This number is not static. By 2031, it is projected to reach 194 million, and by 2050, it will swell to an estimated 347 million nearly one in every five Indians. The elder care market, which encompasses healthcare, housing, mobility, and support services, is currently valued at \$7 to \$8 billion in India and is expected to more than double to \$15 billion by 2030, growing at a compound annual rate of 8 to 10 percent every year. Within this broader elder care market, elderly mobility alone represents a significant and largely untapped segment. When you consider that urban and semi urban elderly populations together number approximately 83 million, and that nearly 40 percent of them require regular transport for medical, social, or essential purposes, the addressable mobility market is conservatively estimated at \$2.5 billion today and projected to reach \$7 billion by 2030. This is not a niche opportunity. This is a large, structural, and growing market that currently has no dominant player serving it at scale.

Key Data Point 2 — Growth Trends

What makes this market particularly compelling is not just its current size but the powerful forces that are driving it upward year after year. Three major trends are converging simultaneously to create an urgent and accelerating demand for elderly mobility solutions in India.

The first trend is demographic. India's elderly population is growing at approximately 3.5 to 4 percent annually, which is significantly faster than the overall population growth rate. This means that every single year, millions more Indians are crossing the age of 60 and entering a life stage where independent mobility becomes difficult, unreliable, or unsafe without dedicated support.

The second trend is social. India's traditional joint family system, which historically served as the primary support network for elderly parents, is rapidly breaking down. Nuclear families are becoming the norm, especially in urban areas. Adult children are migrating to different cities or even different countries for work. As a result, the percentage of elderly living alone in urban India, currently around 15 percent, is expected to rise to 22 percent by 2030 and continue climbing beyond that. More elderly living alone directly translates to higher dependency on external, organized mobility services.

The third trend is healthcare driven. Chronic disease prevalence among India's elderly population is rising sharply. Approximately 40 to 45 percent of elderly Indians suffer from hypertension, 25 to 30 percent have diabetes, and over 800,000 patients currently require dialysis three times every week. Each of these conditions demands regular, frequent, and reliable transport to hospitals, clinics, and treatment centers. These are not

one time trips. They are predictable, recurring rides that happen week after week, month after month which is precisely the kind of demand that a subscription based mobility model is designed to capture and serve efficiently.

Key Data Point 3 — Healthcare Creating Recurring Demand

To truly understand why a subscription model works for elderly mobility, it is important to look at the healthcare driven transport needs of India's elderly population in concrete terms. A dialysis patient, for example, needs to visit a dialysis center three times every week. That translates to 12 to 15 rides per month, every single month, without exception. A cancer patient undergoing chemotherapy needs weekly or bi weekly hospital visits, generating 4 to 8 rides per month. An elderly person managing diabetes requires clinic visits every two weeks, while those with arthritis attend physiotherapy sessions weekly. When you add social trips visits to temples, markets, family gatherings the average elderly user requires anywhere from 10 to 20 rides per month depending on their health condition and lifestyle. At a conservative average fare of ₹200 per ride, families are already spending ₹2,000 to ₹4,000 per month on informal, unreliable transport solutions. A well structured Uber Senior subscription at ₹1,999 per month offering guaranteed rides, trained drivers, and a family tracking dashboard becomes not just an attractive option it becomes an obvious and easy decision for families who are currently spending the same amount with none of the reliability or safety guarantees.

TABLE COMPARING COMPETITORS

Competitor	What They Do	Gap
Anvayaa	Elder care + mobility	Very small scale
Portea Medical	Home healthcare	Not mobility focused
Emoha	Elder care platform	Early stage
Ola	Generic ride hailing	No elderly specific product
Local autos	Informal transport	Unreliable and unsafe

3. Strategic Fit

Uber's Core Capability	What It Means Today	How It Applies to Elderly Mobility
Real Time Ride Matching	Connects riders and drivers instantly across 100+ cities	Can match elderly users with trained, senior certified drivers in their area
Driver Supply Network	Millions of registered, background verified drivers across India	Existing driver pool can be trained and certified for elderly service without recruiting from scratch
GPS & Live Tracking	Real time ride tracking for riders and family members	Family members and caregivers can monitor elderly parent's ride live — solves the single biggest family anxiety
Brand Trust	One of India's most recognized and trusted mobility brands	Families will trust Uber Senior with their elderly parents more than any unknown elder care startup
Payment Infrastructure	Supports UPI, cards, wallets, cash, corporate billing	Subscription billing, auto debit, family account payments, hospital bulk payments — all already possible
Scheduling & Booking System	Advance ride booking already exists on platform	Pre scheduled recurring rides for hospital visits, dialysis, chemotherapy — core elderly use case
Driver Rating & Feedback System	Two way rating system after every ride	Elderly users and families can rate driver behavior, patience, and assistance — quality control built in
Safety Features	SOS button, share trip, 24/7 support already in app	Can be enhanced with elderly specific SOS, caregiver alerts, emergency contact escalation
City Level Demand Data	Years of ride pattern data across Indian cities	Know exactly where elderly hospital clusters are, peak demand times, which neighborhoods have high elderly density
Subscription Infrastructure	Uber One already exists as a subscription product	Uber Senior subscription can be built on the same billing and membership architecture as Uber One
Corporate & B2B Partnerships	Uber for Business already serves enterprise clients	Hospital partnerships, elder care home contracts, insurance TPA billing same B2B framework applies
Multi Language Support	App available in multiple Indian	Critical for elderly users Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Bengali support

Uber's Core Capability	What It Means Today	How It Applies to Elderly Mobility
	languages	already partially exists
Driver App Infrastructure	Drivers manage rides, earnings, and navigation via driver app	Senior mode toggle for drivers filter for elderly rides, training certification badge, higher fare incentive
Surge & Dynamic Pricing Engine	Adjusts pricing based on demand in real time	Can be modified for elderly subscription — fixed, predictable pricing instead of surge, giving families cost certainty
Customer Support System	In app support, phone support, escalation system	Elderly users need phone based support more than chat can be prioritized for Senior tier

4. Business Design

Alternative Business Model 1

Direct to Consumer (D2C) Subscription Model

Uber launches “Uber Senior” as a monthly subscription plan where families pay a fixed fee for a defined number of elderly rides.

Alternative Business Model 2

B2B Institutional Partnership Model

Uber partners with hospitals, dialysis centers, elder care homes, and insurance providers to provide managed elderly transport contracts.

5. Customer Journey

- Families subscribe monthly (₹999–₹2,499 plans)
- Fixed number of rides or unlimited hospital trips
- Access to trained senior certified drivers
- Family dashboard + live tracking included
- Optional add ons (priority support, SOS monitoring)
- Hospitals integrate Uber Senior into the discharge process
- Dialysis centres book recurring rides for patients
- Insurance companies include mobility in care packages
- Elder care homes manage transport via the Uber dashboard
- Uber provides volume based pricing

6. Conclusion

Elderly Mobility & Subscriptions — Uber Senior India

Why This Opportunity Makes Sense

- India's elderly population of 153 million is growing at 3.5 to 4 percent every year, nuclear families are breaking down faster than ever, and chronic disease burden is creating predictable, recurring, high frequency transport demand that no scaled, trusted, technology driven platform is currently serving making this a large, structurally growing, and completely open market that Uber can enter today using capabilities it has already built, including its driver network, live tracking, subscription infrastructure, and brand trust, without needing to start from zero in any meaningful dimension.
- The subscription model is a natural and powerful fit for elderly mobility because the transport need is not random or occasional but deeply routine a dialysis patient needs 12 to 15 rides every single month without exception, a diabetes patient needs clinic visits every two weeks, a cancer patient needs weekly chemotherapy transport which means families are already spending ₹2,000 to ₹4,000 every month on unreliable, untracked, informal transport solutions, and an Uber Senior subscription at ₹1,999 per month offering trained drivers, live family tracking, scheduled ride automation, and an SOS safety system becomes not just attractive but an obvious upgrade that sells itself.
- The competitive landscape presents Uber with a rare first mover opportunity in a high value market segment existing elder care players like Anvayaa and Emoha are too small and too narrowly focused to defend at scale, large ride hailing competitors like Ola have built no elderly specific product whatsoever, local autos offer familiarity but zero technology or safety, and no single player has combined trained drivers, family dashboard, subscription billing, simplified voice booking, and institutional hospital partnerships into one coherent platform meaning Uber can establish dominant market positioning before serious competition arrives.

Risks to Watch Out For

- The biggest and most immediate risk is driver behavior and training consistency elderly passengers are more vulnerable, more sensitive to driver attitude and patience, and less able to self advocate when something goes wrong during a ride, which means that a single bad experience shared by a family on social media or WhatsApp groups where India's elderly care conversations happen can damage trust in Uber Senior disproportionately and significantly, making driver selection, certification, ongoing monitoring, and strong incentive design for senior certified drivers the single most operationally critical risk to manage from day one.
- Technology adoption among India's elderly population remains genuinely low only 35 to 40 percent of Indians above 60 currently own smartphones, regional language voice recognition in Indian languages is still imperfect and prone to errors, and the gap between how Uber's product team imagines elderly users interacting with the app and

how elderly users actually behave in real conditions can be vast and humbling meaning Uber must invest heavily in in person user research with actual elderly participants across different cities, income levels, and language groups before finalizing any product design, because building for an assumed elderly user rather than a real one is a risk that can make the entire product miss its audience entirely.

- The institutional B2B layer hospital partnerships, insurance integrations, dialysis center contracts while highly valuable for long term scale and revenue predictability, carries significant execution risk in the Indian context because hospital procurement cycles are long, bureaucratic, and relationship dependent, insurance TPA integrations require regulatory navigation, and elder care home partnerships require trust building that takes time, meaning Uber must be patient and resource committed in its B2B expansion strategy and must not allow delays in institutional partnerships to slow down or deprioritize the consumer subscription launch which can and should move independently and faster.

What to Test First — MVP / Experiment

- The single most important first experiment Uber should run is a Pilot Subscription Program in one city specifically Bengaluru, given its high elderly urban population, tech savvy adult children, and strong Uber driver density where Uber recruits 200 to 300 drivers for a two week senior sensitivity training program, creates a simplified senior booking flow within the existing Uber app without building a separate app, targets 500 subscribing families through Apollo and Fortis hospital partnerships and NRI community networks, offers the Regular plan at ₹1,999 per month, and measures three things obsessively for 90 days subscription retention rate after month one, family satisfaction score on tracking and safety features, and driver retention rate in the senior certified pool because these three metrics will tell Uber everything it needs to know about whether the product, the pricing, and the operations are working before any significant scaling investment is made.